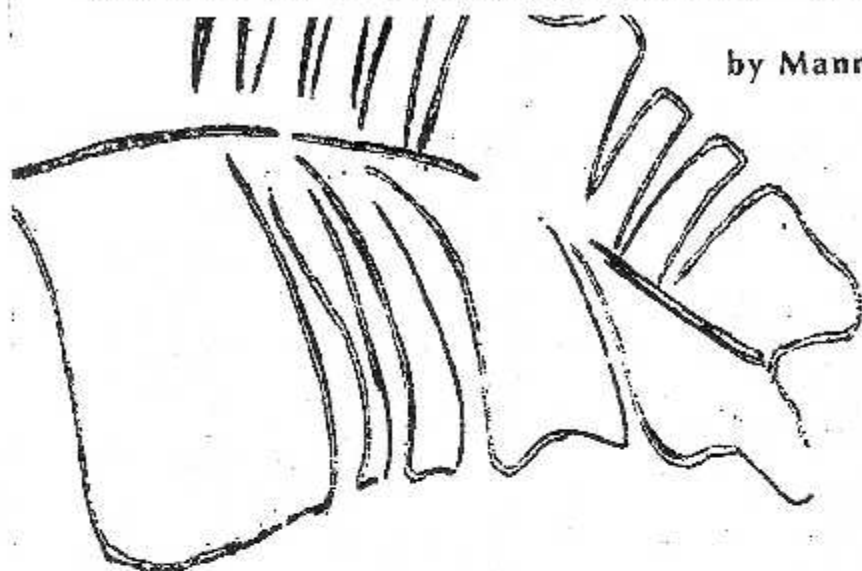


# AFRO-CUBAN KEYBOARD GROOVES

by Manny Patiño and Jorge Moreno



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# LOS TUMBAOS

## (The Comping)

The most important thing in any pop-dance music is "time". Likewise in Afro-Cuban music. The most crucial element, other than the Clave\* which we will discuss soon, is being very conscious of the time/pulse and knowing at all times where the beat is. Peripheral listening, constant adaptation and accommodating to the sounds of the other instruments is very crucial for "locking in" with a real groove. What I mean is an adjustment of the volume, attack and sustain or decay of each note being played in relation to what is "happening" around you. Of course, this interaction is limited when one plays with a drum machine or sequencer (which, by the way, is very good practice for acquiring time).

In playing Afro-Cuban music it is essential that the rhythm section be close together. The section should run like a finely tuned machine. Precision is the key in a music that has so much overlapping of rhythms. One note from any one of its members, that is out of time, will de-tune the "mechanism". Of course, we're not talking about one note in a whole tune, but rather one of the repetitive notes of a pattern that is constantly off. This can also mean an inconsistent time feel or a dragging and/or rushing of one or more notes.

When playing these styles you will realize some similarities between them. Tempos, rhythmic patterns and chord progressions will give each a different flavor. To the musician/listener who is first exposed to Afro-Cuban music it may all sound the same. Long term exposure and careful listening will enable him/her to distinguish the differences.

Some measures in certain tumbaos\*\* can be interchanged depending on the clave. The grooves can be embellished and/or edited with discretion by the player as long as he keeps in mind the underlying accents of the respective clave. As mentioned earlier, the "trick" is to keep your "ears" open at all times. Listen to what is going on around you and how it is relating to what you are doing. If you're critical about your playing and about music in general you will feel the groove when it "locks".

\*Clave (klay-vay): An underlying ostinato rhythmic pattern (used in Afro-Cuban) music whereby all of the syncopations and accents of the overlaying music must be strictly arranged in relation to this ostinato pattern (please see "The Clave").

\*\*tumbao (toom-ba-o): Groove, or comping a groove; vamping on a groove; usually a repetitive two bar rhythmic vamp played by the piano, bass, or tres guitar that must be played in relation to the clave (see page "History Synopsis of Tumbaos").

As you study this concept of clave you will soon realize that there are certain rhythms and melodies that are more "in clave" than others; meaning that the "feel" of the clave is more easily recognizable. You will also realize that a number of patterns and melodic fragments can "be" in either 3:2 or 2:3 clave. There are also phrases that do not really outline or identify the clave of a particular section of a piece, although the remaining rhythmic instruments will be outlining it in their respective tumbaos.

Tunes that start on a given clave whether 3:2 or 2:3 must stay on that clave. There are cases where the melodic phrasing of a section is in 2:3 and a subsequent section is in 3:2. In this case there must be at least two beats (one measure in 2/2 time) added to the music or an odd number of measures in 2/2 time added before entering the subsequent section of the tune (Illus. 2). In other words, the clave pattern must remain constant throughout.

## Illustration 2

Clave 2:3 (C Section) - Clave 3:2 (D Section)

The illustration shows two musical sections, C and D, each with a treble and bass staff. Section C is marked with a 'C' in a box and contains four measures of music. The first measure has a '2' below it, and the second has a '3'. The third measure has a '2' below it, and the fourth has a '3'. The key signature is one flat (B-flat). The notes are: Measure 1: G4, A4, Bb4, A4, G4; Measure 2: F4, E4, D4, C4, Bb3; Measure 3: G4, A4, Bb4, A4, G4; Measure 4: F4, E4, D4, C4, Bb3. Section D is marked with a 'D' in a box and contains four measures of music. The first measure has a '3' below it, and the second has a '2'. The third measure has a '3' below it, and the fourth has a '2'. The key signature is one flat (B-flat). The notes are: Measure 1: F4, E4, D4, C4, Bb3; Measure 2: G4, A4, Bb4, A4, G4; Measure 3: F4, E4, D4, C4, Bb3; Measure 4: G4, A4, Bb4, A4, G4. The text 'etc.' follows the fourth measure.

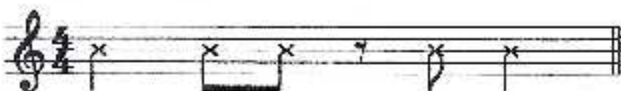
A good exercise in determining a clave is to clap the clave pattern both ways (3:2 or 2:3) and listen to which one feels better with what you're listening to. Try to find the beat in the tumbao that emphasizes the first accent of the "2 side" of the clave or the second accent (bombo accent) on the "3 side". In some cases the "2 side" is a less busy melodic side.

Like any other music, in order to really understand the nuances that give each music its characteristics, one must do a lot of listening and playing. The dynamics and accents are very crucial to obtaining a groove in any music. It is the tumbaos' individual note accents and dynamics that give it the personalized groove. The same notes played by another player will sound slightly different. Through time and practice the grooves will become more natural and you'll instinctively feel the accents of the clave within each groove.



## Cinquillo

Cinquillo (pronounced "SIN-KEY-YO") is a one bar rhythmic pattern that is found throughout Afro-Cuban percussive and melodic phrases.



Cinquillo came into existence with Danzon\* music in Cuba. This music was created by Miguel Failde-Perez in the province of Matanzas in Cuba. In 1877 he wrote "Las Alturas de Simpson" (The Heights of Simpson) named for the town of Simpson in the hills overlooking Matanzas.

The Cinquillo pattern is part of a two-bar vamp that is played on the timbales throughout a Danzon. This in turn has filtered down to become an integral part of many other rhythmic patterns.

It is very important for you to remember this pattern when trying to determine the Clave of any tune. This pattern falls on the "3" side of the Clave.

### "El Manicero" (The Peanut Vendor)



Notice that the Cinquillos fall on the 2nd and 4th bars of the melody.

Of course the Cinquillos are not always as obvious as this one is. You will hear many examples of Cinquillos throughout this book.

\*Danzon is the national dance music of Cuba since the late 1800's.

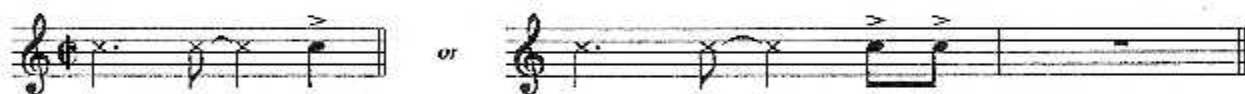
## INTROS & ENDINGS

Intros and endings in Afro-Cuban music are for the most part dependent on the *clave*; although sometimes rules are broken at the very end of a tune. As a rule of thumb, endings are played on the last accented note or notes of a phrase or on a down beat. Many times one part or both sections of the *clave* are played as the ending of a tune (Example A). Endings usually occur either on the last accent (quarter note) or the last two eighth notes of the "3" part of the *clave* (Example B). Although it is not very commonly used, some endings occur on only the first quarter note of either measure of the *clave*. A more commonly used first beat ending is two accented eighth notes (Example C). Some endings outline part of the *clave* (Example D), while adding notes in between the accents (Example E). There are also endings that partially outline the *clave* (Example F).

**Example A**



**Example B**



**Example C**



**Example D**



**Example E**



**Example F**

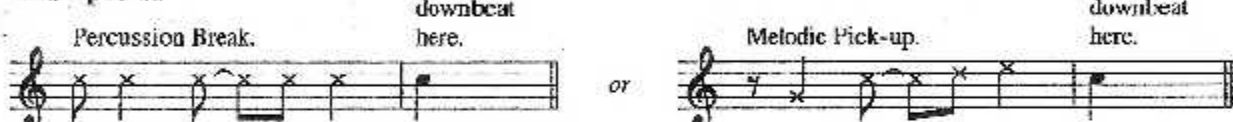


Intros for rhythm section players are treated much the same way as endings. For instance, in a Son Montuno where the pianist might begin a tumbao by himself for four or eight measures, the rest of the rhythm section will enter on the last quarter note of the "3" section of the clave (Example G). Intros can vary depending on a possible percussion break or a melodic pick-up prior to beginning the groove (Example H). Some intros are simply down beats, but more often than not, the intro usually accents a part of the clave (Example I).

### Example G



### Example H



### Example I





## CROSS-OVER GROOVE

Cross-Over is a term used in Latin music to indicate an artist and/or style of music that is accepted and enjoyed by a vast majority of non-Spanish speaking audiences in the U.S. and world wide. The best example of this is Gloria Estefan and the Miami Sound Machine.

In the early 1970's a number of groups from the Miami area started incorporating a drum set (which is not a traditional instrument in Afro-Cuban dance music), electric bass and guitar to play traditional Cuban music. The industry started calling this the Miami sound to differentiate it from the Salsa New York sound.

Gloria Estefan and the Miami Sound Machine took this a step further, and by adding American pop music overtones to their music have created a very unique and successful sound.

In this next example we have chosen a very common four bar two chord piano vamp (tumbao), but by adding some slap-bass tumbaos and drum parts it takes on a whole new feel.

CD

2

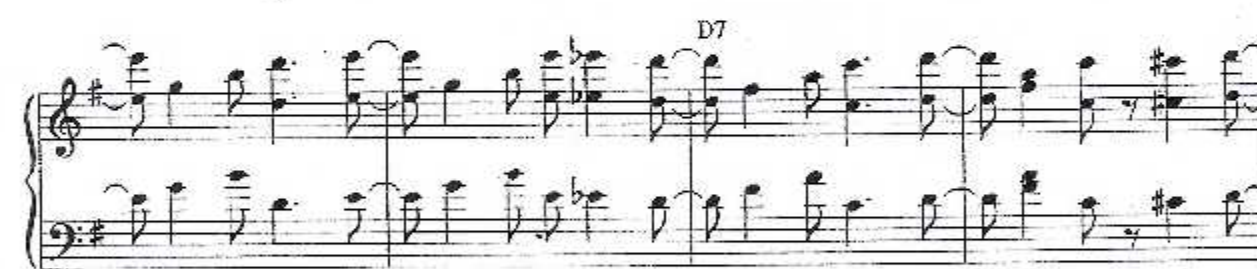
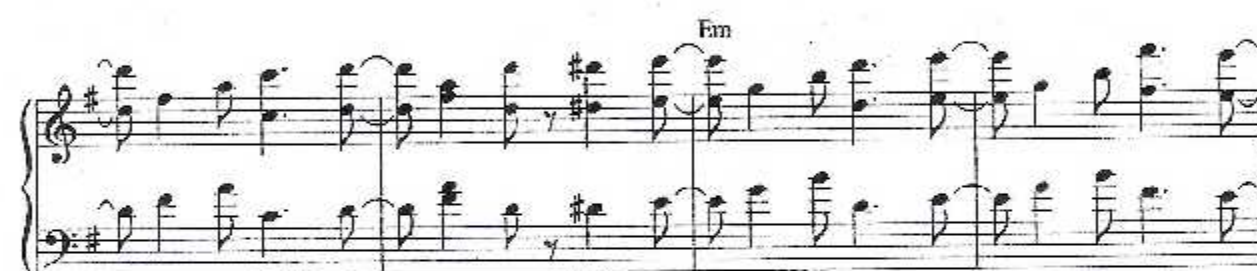
## CROSS-OVER GROOVE

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 1

The musical score consists of three systems of piano accompaniment, each with a treble and bass staff. The first system is a four-bar vamp, with the first two bars marked with an **Em** chord and the last two bars marked with a **D7** chord. The second system is an eight-bar phrase, with the first four bars marked with an **Em** chord. The third system is an eight-bar phrase, with the first four bars marked with a **D7** chord. The music is in 2/3 time and features a rhythmic pattern of eighth and sixteenth notes.





# GUAJIRA

The Guajira style evolved from Cuban country music. The word Guajira literally means "peasant farmer." Guajira can be traced to a form of Spanish music that goes back to medieval times called "Troubadour" music. It was played by singer/poets of the era on a lute or guitar and was sung by rhyming words improvised as they went along.

This form of music was introduced in Cuba by the Spanish colonists that settled the island. It was later adapted by Cuban peasant farmers who called it "punto guajiro" (Note the similarity in the words.) and it is still widely played in Cuba.

Guajira was originally played in an ensemble consisting of a guitar and a tres (A Cuban guitar that is similar in sound to a lute.), with minor percussion such as clave, guiro (scraper) and maracas.

The original chord progression of the "Punto Guajiro" is I-IV-V-V in 2/4 time. But this evolved in the Guajira to a chord progression of I-IV-V-IV-I in a 2:3 clave pattern.

The examples here are in the format adapted by dance bands, where the piano plays vamps similar to those played by the guitar and the tres.

If you wish to listen to more examples of Guajira we recommend recordings by Joseito Fernandez, Beny More, La Sonora Matancera.

CD

3

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 2

## GUAJIRA

CD  
3  
Clave 2:3  
Piano Example 2

Chords: C F G F

Bass pick-up

Chords: C F G F Play 3 times C F

Chords: G F C F G F C



## GUAJIRA

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 3

Measures 1-4 of Piano Example 3. The key signature has one sharp (F#). The melody is in the treble clef, and the bass line is in the bass clef. Chords are indicated above the staff: C, D, G, F, C, D, G, F. The final measure is marked 'F Play 3 times'.

Measures 5-8 of Piano Example 3. The key signature has one sharp (F#). The melody is in the treble clef, and the bass line is in the bass clef. Chords are indicated above the staff: C, D, G, F, C, D, G, F, C.

## GUAJIRA

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 4

Measures 1-3 of Piano Example 4. The key signature has two flats (Bb, Eb). The melody is in the treble clef, and the bass line is in the bass clef. Chords are indicated above the staff: Fm, Bbm, C7, Bbm, Fm, Bbm. A first ending bracket labeled '1.2.3.' covers measures 2 and 3.

Measures 4-6 of Piano Example 4. The key signature has two flats (Bb, Eb). The melody is in the treble clef, and the bass line is in the bass clef. Chords are indicated above the staff: C7, Bbm, Fm, Bbm, C7, Bbm, Fm. A second ending bracket labeled '4.' covers measures 4 and 5.

# SON MONTUNO

SON MONTUNO or "SON" is a very popular form of Cuban dance music that originated primarily in the mountainous province of Oriente.

The word SON derives from the Spanish word "Sonetas" which are poems set to music and MONTUNO from the word "Montaña" which means mountain. Son Montuno or "Songs from the Mountains" were played by the peasant farmers of these regions since the 1800's.

Due to the development of railroads and other forms of public transportation in Cuba during the 1920's this music was exposed to the bigger markets in the major cities. The most important band that popularized "SON" was a "Trio Matamoros" led by Miguel Matamoros.

Son Montuno was originally played in an ensemble consisting of a guitar, a tres and clave.

The usual clave pattern of the Son Montuno is 2:3, but depending on the melody it can also be a 3:2 pattern.

Son Montuno was first adapted by dance bands in the 1920's played with an ensemble of guitar, tres, clave and adding longos, bass and a trumpet. Later with its growing popularity piano, congas and brass were added.

If you wish to listen to more examples of Son Montuno we recommend recordings by Trio Matamoros, Ignacio Pineiro y El Septeto Nacional and La Sonora Matancera.

co  
6

## SON MONTUNO

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 5

The musical score for "Son Montuno" is presented in three systems. The first system shows a simple melody in the right hand and a bass line in the left hand. The second system introduces chords: F6, Bb, C7, and Bb. The third system continues with chords: F6, Bb, C7, Bb, C7, Bb, and F6. The score includes first and second endings marked "1. = 1." and "2.".



## SON MONTUNO

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 6

1

C F G7 F C F G7 F

C F G7 F C F G7 F *Play 4 times*

C F G7 F C F

G7 F C F G7 F

1. C F G7 F 2. C F G7 F C

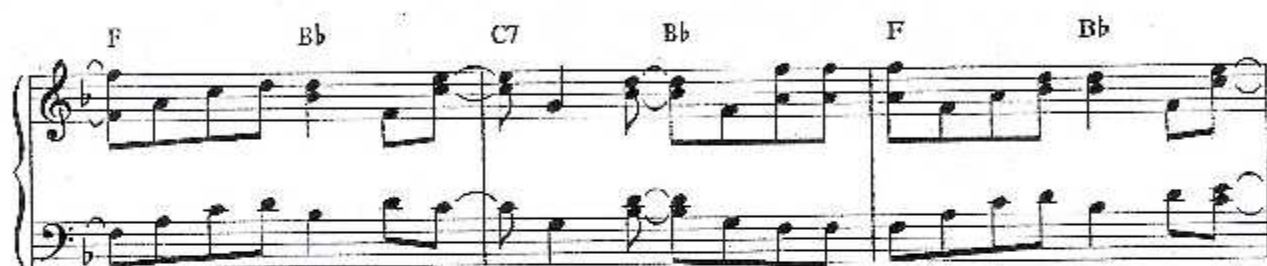
## SON MONTUNO

CD

8

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 7





C7 Bb F Bb C7 Bb

F Bb Em7(b5) A7 Dm9 G13

(Variations not transcribed)

Csus7 C7/Bb F Bb C7 Bb

Play 4 times

F Bb C7 Bb F Bb

Em7(b5) A7 Dm9 G13 Csus7 C7/Bb F

# GUAGUANCO

Guaguanco is a style of music that originated in the Cuban province of Matanzas. During colonial times this part of Cuba was the principal agricultural region, thus it was home to the largest slave population on the island. This created a special mixture of African rhythms and Spanish folk music (flamenco).

Guaguanco was originally played with an array of conga drums and claves creating a rhythm pattern for call and response type melodies. Also a small conga drum approximately six to eight inches wide called a *quinto* is used for fill-in solos throughout.

This ensemble was later adapted by dance bands in the thirties and forties with richer melodies and arrangements and was exposed to larger audiences throughout Cuba.

The examples that are presented here are in the dance band style.

Notice that guaguancos are played with the conga drum and the bass emphasizing a counterpoint against the guaguanco clave.

If you wish to listen to other examples of Guaguanco we recommend recordings by Los Papines, Los Munequitos de Matanzas and Palatos y Totico.

## GUAGUANCO

CD

9

Clave Guaguanco 2:3

Piano Example 8

(Variations not transcribed)

Conga

Clave Guaguanco

Am7

D7/A

Gmaj7

The musical score is written for piano and includes three systems of music. The first system shows the Conga and Clave Guaguanco parts. The second system shows a piano accompaniment for Am7. The third system shows a piano accompaniment for D7/A and Gmaj7. The score is in 2/4 time and features a variety of musical notations, including eighth notes, sixteenth notes, and rests.





# GUAGUANCO

no

10

Clave Guaguanco 2:3

Piano Example 9

(Variations not transcribed)

Conga

Clave Guaguanco

Gm

Gm(maj7)

Gm7

C7

Am

Am(maj7)

Am7



D7                      x                      Gm                      Gm(maj7)

The first system of music consists of two staves. The key signature has one flat (B-flat). The first measure has a D7 chord. The second measure has a Gm chord. The third measure has a Gm(maj7) chord. The music features eighth and sixteenth notes with various accidentals.

Gm7                      C7                      Am

The second system of music consists of two staves. The first measure has a Gm7 chord. The second measure has a C7 chord. The third measure has an Am chord. The music continues with eighth and sixteenth notes.

Am(maj7)                      1. - 4. Am7                      D7

The third system of music consists of two staves. The first measure has an Am(maj7) chord. The second measure has an Am7 chord, with a first ending bracket labeled "1. - 4." above it. The third measure has a D7 chord. The system ends with a double bar line.

15. Am7                      D7                      Gm

The fourth system of music consists of two staves. The first measure has an Am7 chord, with a first ending bracket labeled "15." above it. The second measure has a D7 chord. The third measure has a Gm chord. The system ends with a double bar line.

# GUAGUANCO

Clave Guaguanco 2:3

Piano Example 10

(Variations not transcribed)

Conga

Clave Guaguanco

Am7

D7/A

Gmaj7

Gmaj13

Bm9

E9(b5)

Am7

Ab7(b9)/A

D7(b9,b5)

Gmaj9

Bm9

E9(b5)



Am9 D13(b9)/A



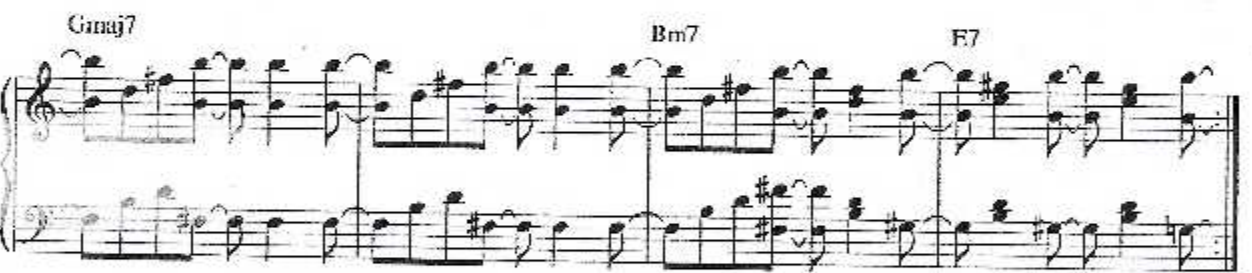
Gmaj7 Bm7 E7



Am9 D13(b9)/A



Gmaj7 Bm7 E7



Am9 D13(b9)/A Gmaj7



# MAMBO

When the word Mambo is mentioned the first name that comes to mind is the famous Perez Prado and his orchestra. But Mambo has a very rich heritage in Cuba.

The first Mambo written was done by two brothers, Orestes and Israel "Cachao" Lopez, in the early 1930's. At the time they were playing piano and bass in Jose Arcano's band "Arcanos y sus Estrellas" in Havana. This band strictly played DANZON music which was the most popular form of Cuban dance music at the time.

The Lopez brothers created a vamp that was used as a bridge or a movement within a Danzon and called it Mambo. Other Danzon bands of the era picked up on this and started to incorporate this new part in their Danzon arrangements.

Later in the 1940's Perez Prado, who was a piano player with Danzon bands in Cuba, used this style to compose and arrange his music.

In 1949 Perez Prado's recording of Mambo #5 became a hit in New York. This started one of the biggest dance crazes to hit the United States and the whole world.

After this, Mambo music was greatly enhanced and developed by such artists as Machito, Tito Puente, Tito Rodriguez, Desi Arnaz (of the Lucy and Desi show) to name a few.

The examples contained here are played in 2:3 clave, although depending on the melody of the song, it may also be played in 3:2 clave.

If you wish to listen to other examples of Mambo we recommend recordings from Perez Prado y su Orquesta, Machito y sus Afro-Cubans, Tito Puente and Tito Rodriguez.

## MAMBO

CD

12

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 11

Chords for Piano Example 11:

System 1: C9, C9(b5), Csus9, C7, C9, C9(b5), Csus9, C7

System 2: F, Fmaj7, F6, Fmaj7, F, Fmaj7, 1:6, Fmaj7, F6

Instruction: Play 4 times



# MAMBO

Clave 2:3  
Piano Example 12

Gm/C      Gm(maj7)/C      Gm//C      C7

F      Fmaj7      F6      Fmaj7      Play 6 times      F

# MAMBO

Clave 2:3  
Piano Example 13

G7

C6

1. - 7.

8.

# CHA-CHA-CHA

As the creator of this music Enrique Jorin himself says: "I named this music Cha-cha-cha because that was the sound I heard coming from the feet of the dancers dancing on those smooth Spanish tiles in Havana's dance halls."

Cha-cha-cha is always played in 4/4 time with an ensemble consisting of a rhythm section of piano, bass, conga, timbales, guiro (scraper) together with string section of violins, cello and a flute.

Though it is in 4/4 time it must be played with a bouncy 2/4 feel.

Since Mr. Jorin himself was a pianist, more so than in other styles that are in this book, the piano vamps in Cha cha cha dictate the feel to the rest of the instruments. It is important to keep this in mind when practicing the examples.

Although Enrique Jorin was the creator of this music, the great Cuban Charanga band "La Orquesta Aragon" has been its most innovative contributor.

With such Cha-cha-cha world-wide hits as "Calculadora", "El Boxiguero", "Los Tamaritos de Olga" and "La Enganadora" just to name a few they are unquestionably the Kings of the Cha cha cha.

If you wish to listen to other examples of Cha-cha-cha we recommend recordings of La Orquesta Aragon, Jose Fajardo y sus Estrellas and Enrique Jorin.

CD

15

## CHA-CHA-CHA

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 14

The musical notation for Piano Example 14 is written in 4/4 time. It consists of three systems of piano accompaniment. The first system has three measures with chords Gm11, C9/G, and Gm11. The second system has three measures with chords C9/G, Gm11, and C9/G. The third system has three measures with chords Gm11, C9/G, and a final measure marked 'Play 4 times' followed by Gm11.



## CHA-CHA-CHA

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 15

Gm7 C7 Gm7 C7 Fmaj7 Fmaj13 Fmaj7 Fmaj13  
 Gm7 C7 Gm7 C7 Fmaj7 Fmaj13 Fmaj7 Fmaj13 *Play 4 times*  
 Gm7 C7 Gm7 C7 Fmaj7

## CHA-CHA-CHA

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 16

Am9 D13 Am9 D13  
 Gmaj13 E7 *Play 4 times* Am9

# BOMBA & PLENA

**Bomba & Plena** — Folk music from Puerto Rico. These grooves are folk styles that emphasize rhythm more than harmony. Although, they may include a "cuatro" (a small guitar native of Puerto Rico similar to the Cuban "tres") as a harmonic accompaniment to the singing. The following musical examples illustrate how these styles would be incorporated in a salsa arrangement.

**Bomba:** The Bomba is traditionally played on three wide barrel drums similar to the conga drums, guiro (scraper), and cencerro (cowbell). Each barrel drum has its own rhythmic pattern. The "requinto" (high pitched drum) improvises over the ostinato pattern the other two drums maintain. The ostinato patterns are one measure in length and do not outline the clave. The piano "comps" a groove in either a 3:2 or 2:3 clave and the bass plays a basic syncopated pattern that may or may not define the clave. Bombas are usually played by salsa ensembles as interludes or as specific sections in a tune.

**Plena:** The Plena originated in Ponce, Puerto Rico. It is traditionally played on tunable panderetas (tambourine-like drums without the rattles), guiro, and accordion. The piano outlines either clave (2:3 or 3:2) while the bass plays a basic Merengue-like pattern with roots and fifths on the downbeats.

## BOMBA

CD

18

Clave 3:2

Piano Example 17

The image displays three staves of piano accompaniment for a Bomba piece, illustrating a 3:2 clave pattern. Each staff consists of four measures, with the chords F, Bb, B, and C7 indicated above the notes. The first staff shows a rhythmic pattern in the right hand (treble clef) and a syncopated bass line in the left hand (bass clef). The second and third staves show variations of this pattern, maintaining the 3:2 clave structure. The notation includes eighth and quarter notes, rests, and chords, with the bass line often featuring a syncopated pattern of eighth and quarter notes.



1.2.

F Bb B C7

3. F Bb B C F

## PLENA

CD  
19

Clave 2.3

Piano Example 18

Am E7/B

Am E7/B Repeat ad lib. & fade out

## MERENGUE

Merengue (merenge) — A sweet delicate candy made with whipped egg-whites and sugar. Popular dance rhythm native of the Dominican Republic.

The merengue evolved from the "perico ripiao"; early folk music that is still played today. "Perico ripiao" was originally played on a guira (cylindrical metal scraper), tambora (two-headed drum played horizontally on the player's lap), and a diatonic button accordion. The marimbula bass\* and alto sax were added later to enhance the existing ensemble.

Of course, this folk music could not be played in society dances where only contra-danzas, danzones, paso dobles and waltzes were played. It was not until the 1940's that the "perico ripiao", now evolved into merengue, entered the ballroom. It was obviously influenced by the big bands in the U.S. A large horn section was added, the piano replaced the accordion, and the upright bass replaced the marimbula. Yet, the essential ingredients of the guira and tambora remained.

There are basically three forms of Merengue:

1. "Merengue Tradicional" which can be played "a media" half of the accents in the tambora pattern, or "corrido" the complete pattern.
2. "Merengue Pambiche" — a slower, easier to dance Merengue. The term comes from the independence war of the Dominican Republic from Spain. The Merengue bands would play slower merengues for the Palm Beach, Florida soldiers stationed in that country. They would play these "Merengues a lo Palm Beach"; hence the word "pam-biche".
3. "Merengue a lo maco" — the most recent innovation to the tambora merengue pattern. A more simplified pattern than the Merengue Tradicional and Merengue Pambiche. It is a one measure pattern that does not outline the clave like the others do.

In the early merengues the piano would "comp" sustained chords during the "body" (A & B sections) of the tune and would segue into a syncopated tumbao in the montuno (vamp) section. The sustained chords at the beginning of the piece were gradually replaced by syncopated tumbaos throughout the whole tune. Eventually the syncopated tumbaos then evolved from identical left and right patterns to a more contrapuntal pattern between the hands.

The primary pattern of the bass was and still is roots and fifths played on down beats. The slower Pambiche Merengue bass also uses roots and fifths but are usually syncopated. The popular Merengue has various fills, glissandos, and nuances added by the arranger or the player to embellish and spice-up the groove. Some of these embellishments included melodic lines in unison with the horn section and staccato, root note down-beats to aid in locking tightly with the bass drum (relatively new to the ensemble) and the rhythm section in general.

Note: Although the clave is not played in the merengues, it is nonetheless implied in the grooves.

If you wish to listen to other examples of merengue we recommend recordings of Johnny Ventura, Wilfrido Vargas, Los Hermanos Rosario, Bony Cepeda, Cuco Valoy, Ramon Orlando, Juan Luis Guerra, Mily & Jocelin y Los Vecinos, J. Esteban y La Patrulla 15, Fernando Villalona.

\*see page 14: "History of Piano and Bass Tumbaos"



# MERENGUE

CD

249

Implied 3:2 Clave  
Piano Example 19



## MERENGUE

CD

21

Implied 3:2 Clave

Piano Example 20







## MERENGUE

CD

22

Implied 3:2 Clave  
Piano Example 21





## MERENGUE

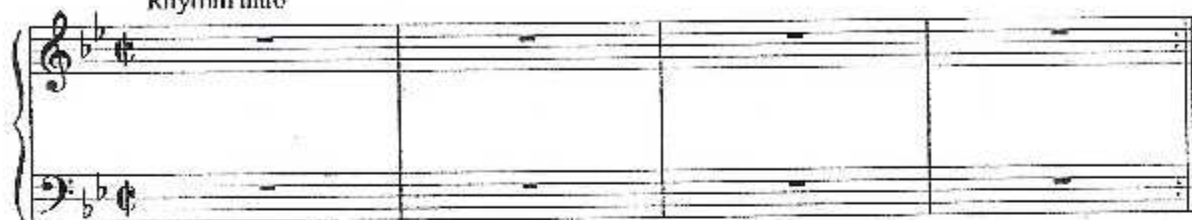
CD

23

Implied 3:2 Clave

Piano Example 22

Rhythm intro





Gm D7 Play 3 times

1

Gm D7/A

Gm

D7/A Gm

# C7 TUMBAO

C7 tumbaos is an open-ended vamp mainly used today for improvisational jam sessions, or as they are called in Latin music "DESCARGAS".

Any 7th chord can be used, but the most commonly used are C7 and D7 chords.

Originally these vamps were used in the "montuno" section of the Danzon style songs in Cuba. Danzon music, being a descendant of the European Contra-Danse, had very structured arrangements which did not allow musicians very much room for improvisation. A new section was added to the Danzon to allow the lead instrument, being the flute in this ensemble, to improvise. Thus a 7th chord was chosen for its dynamic sound and versatility.

The C7 tumbaos when used in this context are always played in 2:3 clave.

Note: The 7th chord tumbaos were first introduced to mass audiences in the famous 1950's series of DESCARGAS recordings by bassist Israel "Cachao" Lopez. These recordings are still available world wide.

en

24

## C7 TUMBAO

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 23

Intro Conga

Bass pick-up

Gm7/C C7 Gm7/C C7 Play 7 times

Gm7/C C7 Gm7/C C7

co

25

## C7 TUMBAO

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 24

Bass pick-up

Soli etc.

Gm/C Gm(maj7)/C



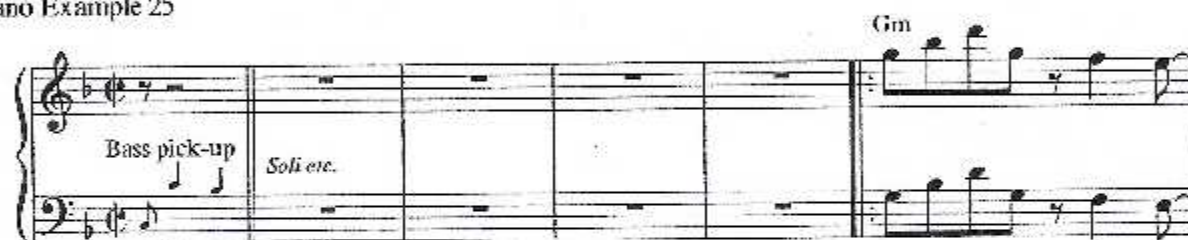


## C7 TUMBAO

CD  
26

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 25



# SONGO

Songo — style created and made popular by Los Van Van of Cuba. Juan Formel (bassist) formed the group Los Van Van in 1970. Along with drummer "Blasito", Formel attempted to merge "Son" with American music. When drummer "Blasito" left the band, Jose' Luis Quintana "Changuito" (conguero, timbalero, and drummer) joined as the new drummer, he developed and elaborated on the style. The result of this endeavor of Los Van Van was named Songo.

The songo "groove" is made by the combination of patterns in the rhythm section. Note that the overall feel of the rhythm section is different. The examples included here are a basic idea of a groove that is much freer and "ad-lib". This groove incorporates a trap set along with bata drums, chekeres, and/or the standard congas, bongos and timbales. The drummer that introduced this groove in the U.S. is Ignacio Berroa (drummer for many years with Dizzy Gillespie). He recorded this groove for the first time in the U.S. with Batacumbela of Puerto Rico. (For a more in depth study of the groove see Ignacio's video "Mastering The Art Of Afro-Cuban Drumming" available from WARNER BROS. PUBLICATIONS.)

## SONGO

CD

27

Clave 3:2

Piano Example 26

The piano example is written in 3/2 time and consists of three systems of music, each with a treble and bass staff. The first system is marked with chords C, D, and G7. The second system is marked with chords F, C, and D. The third system is marked with chords G7, F, and C. The music features a steady eighth-note bass line and a more melodic treble line with various rhythmic patterns and ties.





CD  
28

## SONGO

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 27



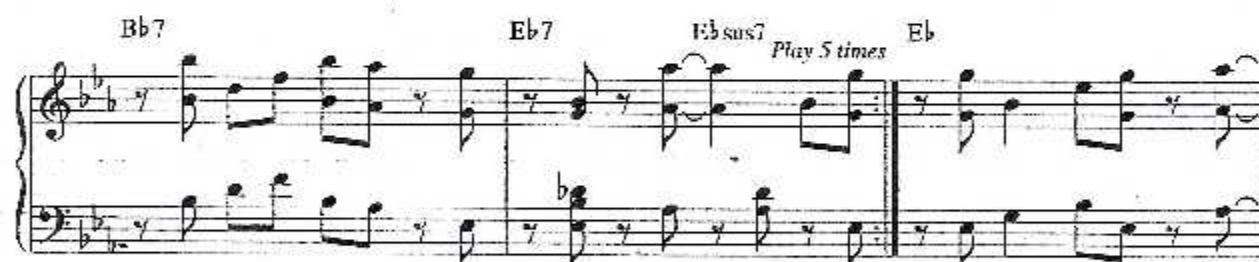
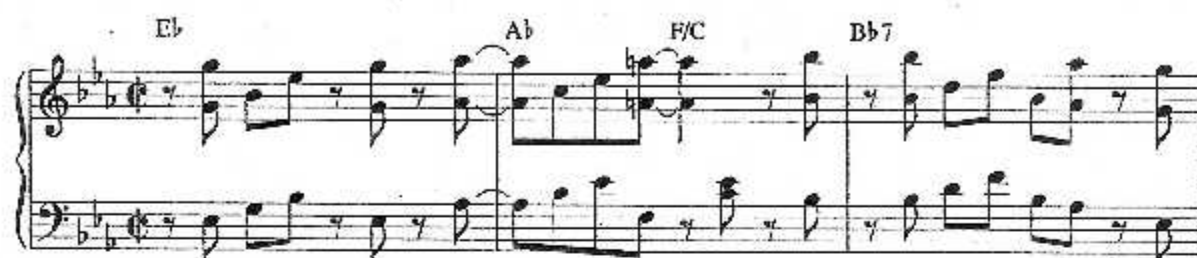
## SONGO

CD

29

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 28





# MUSICA AFRO-CUBANA

Although, the great majority of the grooves in this book are Afro-Cuban, this section includes one of the many grooves that have been played by groups like N.G. La Banda, Adalberto y su son, and Orquesta Revelé among others. Some of the bass and piano examples are more like obligato sections that usually segue into a more standard tumbao. Like the majority of the groups in Cuba, a trap set is also used. And, like the Songo, parts could be and usually are more ad lib. Among many other internationally known Cuban groups are: Irakere, Afro-Cuba, and Rumbavana.

## MUSICA AFRO-CUBANA

CD  
30

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 29

Chord symbols: Gm, Eb, F, F $\sharp$ dim/C, Gm, Gm.

## MUSICA AFRO-CUBANA

CD  
31

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 30

Chord symbols: F, B $\flat$ , B, C7, C $\sharp$ dim, Dm, F.





# SALSA

33

Salsa is a name that originated in New York City during the 1970's to describe the sound that had been evolving for a number of decades. It is a mixture of many cultures, but mainly it is Afro-Cuban music, especially the "guaracha" (descendant of the son) with Puerto Rican percussive additions and American Jazz harmonic enhancements.

It would be impossible to name all of the artists and musicians who influenced this music, but it would be helpful for you to obtain some recordings of the following individuals, all of whom made significant impact on this music:

Ray Barreto, Justo Betancourt, Wille Colon, Bobby Cruz, Celia Cruz, Larry Harlow, Hector La Voie, Ismael Miranda, Johnny Pacheco, Eddie Palmieri, Charlie Palmieri, Richie Ray, Pete "El Conde" Rodriguez, Ismael Quintana and Bobby Valentín.

The above mentioned artists primarily performed a hard-driving form of Salsa that was very danceable, but at the same time gave the players a lot of room for improvisation.

In recent years a form of Salsa called "Salsa Sensual" has become very popular. This form of Salsa still maintains the same rhythmic and clave patterns, but the arrangements are built around romantic ballads with the chords and harmonies for a more mellow sound.

Lately the contributions of Venezuelan, Colombian and Panamanian musicians have given the music a different flavor. Musicians like Oscar de Leon from Venezuela and El Grupo Niche from Columbia have added idiosyncracies in tumbaos, mambos and overall song structures, and from Panama Ruben Blades' use of different instrumentation as well as structure has elevated the music to newer heights.

Not to mention El Gran Combo and La Sonora Ponceña from Puerto Rico whose Jazz influenced Papo Lucca has given the music a fresh new twist.

In the following examples you will hear both of these styles extensively.

## SALSA

CD

33

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 32

Ab A5m

1. - 5. 6.

Bb Bbm7 Eb7 Eb

## SALSA

CD

34

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 33

Piano Example 33 is a salsa piano accompaniment piece in 2/3 time, featuring a clave pattern of 2:3. The piece is divided into five systems, each with a specific chord progression and notation. The notation includes a treble and bass staff with a piano (p) dynamic marking. The chords are indicated above the staff.

**System 1:** Dm9, G13(b9)

**System 2:** Cmaj9, Em7, A9

**System 3:** Dm9, G13(b9)

**System 4:** Cmaj9, Em7, A9, *Play 3 times*

**System 5:** Dm9, G13(b9), Cmaj7



# SALSA

CD

35

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 34

Dm13 G13

First system of piano notation. The treble staff has a Dm13 chord at the beginning and a G13 chord later. The bass staff has a Dm13 chord at the beginning and a G13 chord later. The music is in 2/3 time and features a clave rhythm.

Cmaj13

Second system of piano notation. The treble staff has a Cmaj13 chord at the beginning. The bass staff has a Cmaj13 chord at the beginning. The music is in 2/3 time and features a clave rhythm.

Em11 A7(b9) Play 5 times Dm13

Third system of piano notation. The treble staff has an Em11 chord at the beginning, followed by an A7(b9) chord, and then a Dm13 chord. The bass staff has an Em11 chord at the beginning, followed by an A7(b9) chord, and then a Dm13 chord. The music is in 2/3 time and features a clave rhythm.

G13 Cmaj13

Fourth system of piano notation. The treble staff has a G13 chord at the beginning and a Cmaj13 chord later. The bass staff has a G13 chord at the beginning and a Cmaj13 chord later. The music is in 2/3 time and features a clave rhythm.

## SALSA

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 35

(Variations not transcribed)

Am7(b5) D7(b5,b9) Gm9 C9 Am7(b5) D7(b5,b9)

Gm9 C9 Am7(b5) D7(b5,b9) Gm9 C9

Am7(b5) D7(b5,b9) Gm9 C9 Am7(b5) D7(b13,b9)

Gm11 C7(#9) Am7(b5) D7(b13,b9) Gm11 C7(#9) Am7(b5) D7(b5,b9)

Gm9 C9 Am7(b5) D7(b5,b9) Gm9 C9



Variations

Am7(b5) D7(b5,b9) Gm9 C9 Am7(b5) D7(b5,b9) Gm9 C9

Am7(b5) D7(b5,b9) Gm9 C9 Am7(b5) D7(b5,b9) Gm9 C9

Am7(b5) D7(b5,b9) Gm9 C9 Am7(b5) D7(b5,b9) Gm9 C9

Am7(b5) D7(b5,b9) Gm9 C9 11. Am7(b5) D7(b5,b9)

Gm9 C9 12. Am7(b5) D7(b5,b9) Gm9

## SALSA

CD

37

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 36

(Variations not transcribed)

Dm7 G9 Cmaj7 F9 Bm7(b5) E7(b9,b5)

Am7 D9/E Dm7 G9 Cmaj7 F9

Bm7(b5) E7(b9,b5) Am7 D9/E Dm7 G7alt

Cmaj13 F13 G9/B E7alt Am9,13 Em7(b5) A7(b5,b9)



Dm9,13      G7(b9+5)      Cmaj13      F9      G9/B      E7alt

Am9      D9/E (D)      Dm7      G9      Cmaj7      F9

Bm7(b5)      F7(b9,b5)      Am7/D      D9      Dm7      G9

Cmaj7      F9      Bm7(b5)      F7(b9,b5)      Am7      D9/E

Dm7      G7alt      Cmaj13      F13      G9/B      E7alt      Am/D

## SALSA

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 37

Bm7

Am7

D7

Play 6 times

Gmaj9

## SALSA

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 38

(Variations not transcribed)

Am9

D7(b13, #9)

Gm9

C13

Am9

D(b13, #9)



Chord progression: Gm9, C13(#11), Am9, D(b13, #9)

Chord progression: Gm9, C7, C7(b9), Am9

Chord progression: D(b13, #9), Gm9, C13

1. 2. Chord progression: Am9, D(b13, #9), Gm9

3. Chord progression: C13, Am9, D(b13, #9), Gm9

## SALSA

CD

40

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 39

(Variations not transcribed)

The image displays four systems of piano accompaniment for a Salsa piece. Each system consists of a treble and bass staff. The chords and their durations are as follows:

- System 1:** Dm6 (4 bars), Eb7 (4 bars), Dm6 (4 bars).
- System 2:** Eb7 (4 bars), Eb9 (4 bars), Dm6 (4 bars), Eb9 (4 bars).
- System 3:** Dm6 (4 bars), Eb9 (4 bars), *Play 10 times* Dm6 (4 bars).
- System 4:** Eb9 (4 bars), Dm6 (4 bars), Eb9 (4 bars), Dm6 (4 bars).

The bass lines are composed of eighth and sixteenth notes, often with triplets, providing a rhythmic foundation for the chords. The key signature is one flat (Bb).



## SALSA

CD  
41

Clave 3:2

Piano Example 40

The image displays four systems of piano accompaniment for a salsa piece, written in 4/4 time with a 3:2 clave rhythm. The notation is in treble and bass staves.

**System 1:** The first system is marked "Bass" and "7". It features a simple bass line in the bass staff and a melody in the treble staff. The second measure of the system is marked "Dm7".

**System 2:** The second system is marked "G7", "Em7", and "A7". It continues the melody and bass line with more complex harmonic support.

**System 3:** The third system is marked "1. - 5." and "Dm7". It includes a first ending bracket over the first two measures, which then lead into a second ending marked "Dm7".

**System 4:** The fourth system is marked "A7", "6.", "Dm7", "G7", and "Cmaj9". It includes a second ending bracket over the first two measures, which then lead into a final ending marked "Cmaj9".

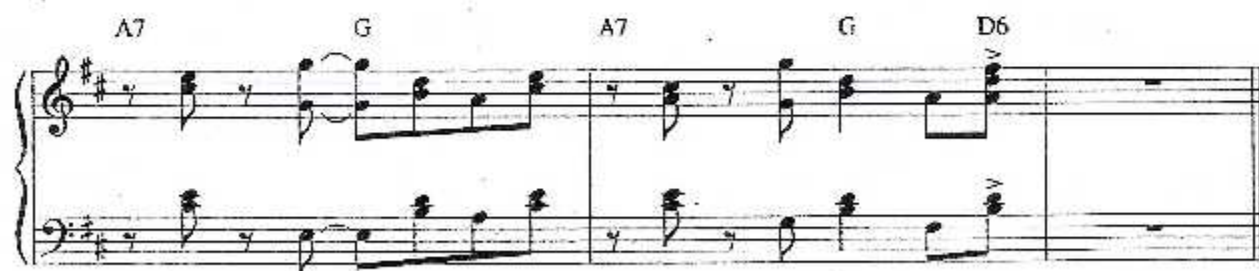
## SALSA

CD

42

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 41





# SALSA

CD

43

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 42: This is the same piano part as Example 41 only with a variation in the slap bass part on the accompanying CD.

The piano score for Salsa Example 42 consists of four systems of music, each with a treble and bass staff. The key signature is one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4. The chords indicated above the staves are D6, G, and A7. The first system has six measures with chords D6, G, A7, G, A7, and G. The second system has four measures with chords D6, G, A7, and G. The third system has four measures with chords A7, G, D6, and G, with the instruction "Play 10 times" written above the third measure. The fourth system has five measures with chords A7, G, A7, G, and D6. The bass line features a consistent rhythmic pattern of eighth and sixteenth notes.

## SALSA

co

44

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 43

Gm Am7(b5)

D7(b9) Am7(b5) D7(b9)

1.-5. Eb F Gm7 C9 6. Eb F Gm7 C9 Gm/C

## SALSA

co

45

Clave 3:2

Piano Example 44

(Variations not transcribed)

Dm7 G7



Cmaj9      Fmaj7      Bm7(b5)/D      E7(b9)

Am7      A7(b9)      Dm7      G7

Cmaj9      Fmaj7      Bm7(b5)/D      E7(b9)

Am7      A7(b9)      *Play 4 times* Dm7      G7

Cmaj9      Fmaj7      Bm7(b5)/D      E7(b9)      Am

## LATIN JAZZ

Before the word Latin Jazz was used to describe this music it was called "Afro-Cuban Jazz" or as Dizzy Gillespie and other musicians at the time amusingly called it, "CuBop". The first to play this was Mario Bauza, the arranger for Jose "Machito" Grillo's band in the forties in New York.

Mario Bauza had played with such big bands as Chick Webb and Cab Calloway when he first got to the states from Cuba in the 1930's. Here he created "Tanga", the first known composition that used a jazz melody and harmonies with a Cuban clave feel and rhythm section. Later with his brother-in-law Machito's band and later on his own he continued to compose and record numerous albums of Latin Jazz and dance music until his death in 1993.

Another important influence during the 1940's was Dizzy Gillespie's composition of "Manteca" which was composed in conjunction with Chano Pozo, a Cuban percussionist introduced to Dizzy by Mario Bauza. By his love for Afro-Cuban music and openly associating himself with this music Dizzy Gillespie attracted many other great Bebop players of the era to it.

It is impossible for us to list all of the artists in this field, nevertheless we made a condensed list of the following: Mario Bauza, Machito y su Orchesta, Tito Puente, Dizzy Gillespie, Mongo Santamaria, Cal Tjader, Ray Barreto, Grupo Irakere, Poncho Sanchez and Gonzalo Rubalcaba.

CD

46

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 45

## LATIN JAZZ

The musical score for Piano Example 45 is written for piano and features a 2:3 Clave rhythm. The key signature is B-flat major (three flats). The score is divided into three systems, each with a treble and bass staff. The chord symbols above the notes are as follows:

- System 1: Fm7, Bbm7, Eb7
- System 2: Abmaj7, Dbmaj7, Dm7, G7
- System 3: Cmaj13, Cm7



Fm7 Bb7 Ebmaj7

Abmaj7 Adim7 D7(b9) Gmaj13

Am7 D9

Gmaj13 F#m7

B7 Fmaj7 Caug7(b9)





Dbmaj9      Dm9      G13(b5)      Cmaj13

Cm7      Fm7

Bbsus9      Bb9      Ebmaj9      Abmaj7

(Am7b5      D7)      Gmaj9

Am9/D (D7) Ab9/D Gmaj9/D

F#m9 B13 Emaj13 C(#9,b13)

Fm7 Bbm7 Ebsus9 Eb(9,b5) Abmaj9

Dbmaj7 Dbm7 Cm9

Bdim7 Bbm9 Ebsus13 Eb13 Abmaj9



## LATIN JAZZ

Clave 2:3

Piano Example 46

Variations not transcribed

System 1: Bm7(b5) E7(b9) Am7 D9 Bm7(b5) E7(b9)

System 2: Am7 D9 Dm7 G9 Cmaj7 F9

System 3: Bm7(b5) E7(b9) Am7 D9 Bm7(b5) E7(b9) Am7 D9

System 4: Bm7(b5) E7(b9) Am7 D9 Dm7 G9 Cmaj7 F9

System 5: 1. Bm7(b5) E7(b9) Am7 D9 2. Bm7(b5) E7(b9) Am/D

## LATIN JAZZ

CD

48

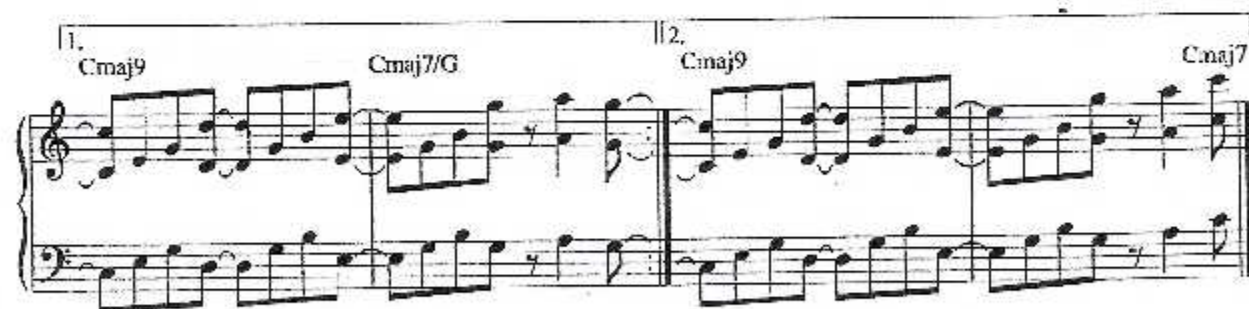
Clave 3:2

Piano Example 47

Piano Example 47 is a Latin Jazz piece in C major, 3/2 time, featuring a 3:2 clave rhythm. The piece consists of five systems of piano accompaniment, each with a treble and bass staff. The chords and melodic lines are as follows:

- System 1:** Chords: C6, Cm7. The melody in the treble staff starts with a half note C4, followed by quarter notes D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, and C5. The bass staff plays a steady eighth-note pattern.
- System 2:** Chords: D7/C, Db/C, C6. The melody in the treble staff starts with a half note C4, followed by quarter notes D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, and C5. The bass staff plays a steady eighth-note pattern.
- System 3:** Chords: Dm7, G9, C6. The melody in the treble staff starts with a half note C4, followed by quarter notes D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, and C5. The bass staff plays a steady eighth-note pattern.
- System 4:** Chords: Fm7, Bb7. The melody in the treble staff starts with a half note C4, followed by quarter notes D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, and C5. The bass staff plays a steady eighth-note pattern.
- System 5:** Chords: Ebmaj7, Dm7, G7, Cbmaj7. The melody in the treble staff starts with a half note C4, followed by quarter notes D4, E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, and C5. The bass staff plays a steady eighth-note pattern.





## LATIN JAZZ

CD

49

Piano Example 48  
(Variations not transcribed)

Rhythm Intro 4

4

Fm Fm6

Fm Bbm Bbm(maj7)

Bbm/- Bbm(maj7) Fm

1.  
Db7



C7

|| 2. Db7

C7

Fin

Rhythm

23

23

## MIXING THE STYLES

Styles in Afro-Cuban Music are sometimes mixed adding variety to the music. This creates a sort of tension and release within a given tune. For example, a tune may start as a Bolero for sixteen or thirty-two measures and segue into Salsa. Styles are interchanged with discretion. When done eloquently, the change is accepted naturally by the listener. Many mixes are made as intros, interludes, verse or body of a tune, or as an ending section within a piece. Four, eight or sometimes sixteen measures at a time are incorporated and usually done once or twice within a section to add some spice.

A few common groove mixes include:

1. Salsa with a quasi-Samba section and/or ending
2. Bolero with a quasi-Samba or Bossa Nova ending
3. Salsa with a Bomba section
4. Merengue with a Bolero intro
5. Merengue with the conguero playing Puerto Rican Plena (a mix within the style)
6. Bolero that segues into Salsa
7. Salsa with a Guaguanco intro and/or interlude
8. Salsa with 6/8 bata' drumming intro and/or interlude
9. Merengue with a Rap section
10. Salsa with other unnamed grooves created within the rhythm section i.e., caballo

## CONCLUSION

We hope that you have enjoyed this study and have been able to use it in developing your own grooves. As mentioned in the beginning, this book should be used as basis for studying the over-all concept of the styles. It is merely a brief survey of the tip of an "iceberg" that continues to grow and develop with time. If you've studied and practiced these examples thoroughly you should by now be able to tap the clave to the examples and create a tumbao over a set of changes that fit the respective clave. We thank you for listening.

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